

Idempotency, retry and amount safety policy

Policy intent

Prevent advisory recovery from repeating an uncertain operation or exceeding synthetic amount bounds. New-key retries, releases, refunds and notification replays are operational actions requiring separate human authority.

The Lifecycle Owner owns identity rules; stage owners confirm original outcomes and recovery eligibility. The copilot may identify missing prerequisites but may not execute a retry or infer that absence of an acknowledgement means failure.

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Owner	Payment Lifecycle Owner
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Approver	Knowledge Approver (fictional role)
Scope	authorization, capture, release, refund, delivery
Risks / sources	R02, R03, R04, R05, R06, R07, R08, R10, R11, R15 / E02, E03, E04, E05, E06, E08, E10

Synthetic notice: All systems, records, roles and amounts are fictional. Guidance is advisory and never executes an action.

Required identity and amount controls

Operation identity

A tenant-scoped idempotency key with the same canonical payload identifies one logical operation. Reuse with a changed payload must be treated as conflict. A new key must not be used as a workaround for an unknown original outcome. Event identity and operation identity must remain distinct: repeated message delivery is not another payment, capture or refund.

Before a retry/replay recommendation, the responsible owner must establish the original outcome, downstream operation identity, duplicate handling and applicable effective policy. Unknown receipt or outcome blocks a safe-repeat conclusion. The advice must name which source would resolve the missing prerequisite.

Amount invariants

Only positive integer SYN_UNIT request amounts are supported. Confirmed capture sums must not exceed confirmed authorization amount; confirmed refund sums must not exceed confirmed captured amount. Pending/unknown exposure reserves headroom and must not be ignored. Partial operations must be distinct and linked; duplicate event acknowledgements must not be counted twice without identity analysis.

Reversal applies only to unconsumed authorization and cannot refund captured units. Local cancellation does not establish release. Missing expiry/hold confirmation must not be replaced by elapsed time. Any invariant breach or conflicting final record requires investigation, not silent source correction.

Recovery authority

Every separately authorized recovery requires named owner, exact operation scope, approved procedure, validation checkpoint and stop conditions. Report approval does not supply this authorization. Security controls must not be bypassed to retry a failed request or deliver an event.

Governance and evidence retention

Responsibilities

Owner	Control responsibility
Lifecycle Owner	Maintain logical operation/key/payload linkage and cross-stage identity
Capture / Refund / Gateway Owners	Confirm original results and amount/hold eligibility
Delivery Owner	Confirm original recipient outcome and replay duplicate handling
Payment Operations	Keep missing prerequisites and uncertainty visible in advice

Exceptions

No exception authorizes automatic retries, omission of pending exposure or changes to immutable source history. Unsupported mechanisms such as split tender, fees, FX or incremental authorization must not be invented to explain amount breaches. New domain semantics require versioned owner decisions before authoring or runtime use.

Verification and change review

Owners must retain original and successor operation IDs, canonical payload identity, confirmed/pending arithmetic, source acknowledgements, effective rule and separate human approval. Validation must distinguish local projection repair from a new downstream operation. Configuration rollback cannot undo a confirmed payment operation; any compensating operation needs its own identity and approval.

Review on idempotency, amount, source-authority or recovery-procedure changes. E02-E10 referenced here are future read-only requirements; current aggregate service errors cannot establish safe retry or headroom. Q6 LOW/null requirements remain applicable to degraded/empty report evidence.

Related guidance and revision

Related documents: RB-103, RB-104, RB-105, RB-106, RB-108, PL-105.

Version 1.0.0, effective 2026-10-01. Initial independent risk-derived issue. Review cadence: annual, or before a material domain/source/control change.